Analog Digits Font Pack vol. 2 the user guide

by Speak the Sky

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Readme

The license

You can freely (i.e. without royalties) use the fonts in this font pack (i.e. the .otf, .woff, and .woff2 files for cursiv8, tEggst, and reLix) in both personal and commercial projects as long as you purchased the pack from the designer. Currently, the only place where this font pack is sold is on itch, at the following url:

speakthesky.itch.io/typeface-analog-digits-pack-2

You may modify the font files, but not redistribute the original or modified font files in themselves as free or paid products.

Troubleshooting

These fonts use OpenType (OT) features. In apps that support OT features, you can usually activate them in a menu with a name like “Text Style”, “Typography”, etc. For more info, read your app’s documentation. Some apps have limited OT support (e.g. MS Word has the “standard ligatures” feature switched off by default and can’t activate the “character variant” features).

Credits

cursiv8, tEggst, and reLix by **Speak the Sky** using **Glyphs**.
User Guide body: **Overpass** by **Delve Fonts** (license: **OFL-1.1**).
Glyph table legacy computing symbols: **Unscii** by **Viznut** (license: public domain).
User Guide titles and headings: **Comfortaa** by **Johan Aakerlund** (license: **OFL-1.1**).

Version History

2022-05-20:

- Analog Digits Font Pack volume 2 v1.0 is released:
  - cursiv8 v1.0
  - tEggst v1.0
  - reLix v1.0

Introduction

Here's what you get

Analog digits

The fonts in this pack are based on different types of analog electronic display (analog as in "not pixels" here). Each font's set up to help you make graphics of a different kind of numerical display, from eggcrate lightbulb gameshow boards to cursive 8-segment displays.

Mostly numerals

Most of the characters you can type in these fonts are numerals (1 to 9 and 0) and a few punctuation marks (e.g. decimal points) and maths operators (e.g. plus and minus) that are helpful for imitating those displays. These fonts are not full text fonts, nor are they meant to be, nor will they ever be! **Exception:** tEggst.

Layer fonts

Each font has different layers for different parts of the display, such as the lit and unlit bulbs of an eggcrate display. This lets you separately change each layer's colour and effects (like glow). You can see how much more control that gives you in the cover pages of this user guide, among other places.

Precomposed glyphs

You can use the layers to build graphics piece by piece, but each font also comes with sets of precomposed (pre-built) glyphs for when you don't want/need to (or can't) go into all that detail.

How to use the layers

It's simple: to build graphics out of these layer fonts... just make several layers of text stacked on top of each other, and apply different OpenType (OT) features to match each layer's position. You can find more about OpenType features and how to use them later in this section, but basically they're like switches that let you change how some or all of a font's characters look.

The fonts in this pack use "stylistic set" OT features to change between layers. For example, in the lightguide font, reLix, by default you type the lit forms for each number, and switching on "stylistic set 1" (or, ss01) lets you type the unlit forms for that same number:

1 3 5 7 9	
13579 (default)	13579 (ss02 on)

See how, e.g. typing 3 in the default mode shows a thicker, lit-up numeral, but with ss01 switched on the segments you see is the thin, etched numeral that appears when no light is shone on the display. Each layer uses the same text (try copying and pasting the table above if you don't believe me), just with different OT features applied.

Here's how it looks with the lit layer on top of the unlit layer, plus some colours:

OpenType Features

What is OpenType?

OpenType is a font format with special features—OpenType/OT features—that let you change how a font looks and behaves, *if* the font has those features.

Which OT features do the fonts have?

cursiv8 and reLix use these features:

- **stylistic sets** let you swap out a large group of glyphs for a set with a different style
- **character variants** let you swap out a small group of glyphs to fine-tune a font's appearance
- **proportional figures/numbers** replace fixed-width numerals (and other characters) with versions that have widths proportionate to the characters
- **standard** and **discretionary ligatures** (cursiv8 and reLix) replace series of glyphs with single glyphs

Standard ligatures are normally on by default and discretionary are always off. You can usually activate ligatures in the same places as other OT features.

tEggst is unusual in the Analog Digits Font Packs in that it's a normal font with text, numerals, punctuation, and other symbols. You can find out more about it in its own section.

For best results, only switch on one of cursiv8's, tEggst's, or reLix's stylistic sets for a given piece of text or text style.

How to Activate OT Features

...in the Affinity Suite

There are at least 3 ways to switch on OT features in **Affinity Suite** apps like Affinity Publisher:

A. **The Typography pop-up,** found through the top menu through **Text > Show Typography**, with its keyboard shortcut. This lets you control features for text you're selecting.

B. **The Character studio panel,** switched on through the top menu through **View > Studio > Character**. This panel's Typography section lets you control features for text you're selecting.

C. **The Text Styles studio panel,** switched on similarly to the Character panel. This lets you edit text styles by right-clicking a style's name or left-clicking the icon to its right, then choosing 'Edit'. You can find stylistic set, character variant, and other settings in the style editing pop-up under **Typography > Alternates** and **Variants**.

...in LibreOffice

You can switch on OT features in LibreOffice apps that allow you to use and edit text styles, like LibreOffice Writer.

There are two ways to switch on OT features in LibreOffie Writer:

A. **The Character pop-up,** found through the top menu through **Format > Character**. In the 'Font' tab, click the 'Features' button to open a menu for activating features for text you're selecting.

B. **The Text Styles panel,** switched on in a number of ways, including in the top menu through **Styles > Manage Styles**. This lets you edit text styles by right-clicking a style and choosing 'Modify'. In the style editing pop-up's 'Font' tab, click the 'Features' button to open a menu for activating features for that style.

NOTE FOR OPENOFFICE: Apache OpenOffice does not support OpenType substitutions. As OpenOffice has been discontinued, it's unlikely any of the fonts in this pack will ever work in this software.

...in MS Office

These instructions are for Word from Microsoft Office 365.

There are two ways to switch on OT features in MS Office:

A. **The Font Format pop-up,** found in the top menu under **Format > Font** with its keyboard shortcut. The 'Advanced' tab lets you control features for text you're selecting.

B. **The Text Styles menu,** found in the 'Home' section of the ribbon menu. This lets you edit text styles by right-clicking a style and choosing 'Modify'. In the style editing pop-up, choose 'Font' from the drop-down menu in the lower left, then click the 'Advanced' tab for feature settings.

IMPORTANT: MS Office has incomplete support for OT features:

- You can't switch on character variants;
- **You need to switch on standard ligatures manually.** You can do this in the 'Advanced' tab mentioned above.
- Other MS Office apps (e.g. Powerpoint, Publisher) do not support OT features.

...in Scribus

You can switch on OT features in Scribus in the **Style Manager pop-up** found in the top menu under **Edit > Styles** with its keyboard shortcut. Choose or create a new text style and find the 'Font Features' tab (for Paragraph Styles, find it under the Character Style tab).

The menu here lets you switch on some, but not all OT features, including stylistic sets.

IMPORTANT: Scribus doesn't allow you to switch on character variants (as of v1.5.6.1, on Mac).

...in Apple Pages and TextEdit

You can switch on OT features in both Apple Pages and TextEdit by opening the **Fonts pop-up**, found through the top menu through **Format > Font > Show Fonts** along with its keyboard shortcut. Click the gear menu icon, then 'Typography' to open a pop-up that lets you control features for the text you're selecting (which you can bake into that text's style using the 'Update' button in the **Text Style panel** on the right).

IMPORTANT: These apps have limited support for OT features and user fonts:

- User-installed fonts may not be available in the drop-down font menu, in which case they must be selected through the Fonts pop-up.
- Neither app supports character variants.

...in Inkscape

You can switch on OT features in Inkscape in the **Text and Font panel**, found through the top menu under **Text > Text and Font** with its keyboard shortcut. Select a text object, navigate to the Font tab of the panel, select and apply your chosen font using the list and 'Apply' button, then navigate to the Features tab and open the drop-down menus to activate OT features:

- ligature settings are under the 'Ligatures' menu.
- proportional figures settings are under the 'Numeric' menu.
- stylistic set and character variant settings are under the 'Feature Settings' menu.

Accessibility

Every layer of a layer font is its own piece of text. This means that e.g. a full set of cursiv8 layers will consist of the same text twice, once for the lit segments layer and once again for the unlit layer. Text-to-speech apps will read the same text twice.

This isn't a show-stopping accessibility problem, because these fonts are designed to be used in images for short stretches of numbers, not long text. However, it could be a bit confusing or annoying. For a better reading experience, try one of these options (not all of these will work for any given app):

- convert the text to shapes/curves (e.g. the Affinity Suite's "Convert to Curves" option).
- put the text in a shape or text box and apply alt-text (e.g. in LibreOffice or MS Word).
- use the fonts in an image editor (e.g. GIMP, Adobe Photoshop), export images in pixel formats (e.g. .png, .jpg, .gif), then import the images into your text.

I can't guarantee that the second option will work, but the first and third will (the first is used in this guide).

cursiv8

Introduction

Vacuum fluorescent displays

Vacuum fluorescent displays (VFDs) make light by sending electrons from a cathode (electron source) to an anode (electron sink) coated in phosphorus that glows when electrons travel through it. Anodes could be made in the shape of symbols (e.g. play, rewind), tick-marks (e.g. on clocks or speedometers), words (e.g. “HIGH”, “LOW”), or the segments of an 8-segment display, among other things.

8-segment displays show different numbers by lighting up segments in the shape of each number. The Sharp QT-8D (1969) and EL-8 (1971), some of the earliest electronic hand calculators, displayed outputs via unusual handwriting-styled 8-segment VFDs. The displays were coloured a medium green or slightly-bluish green, but could probably be manufactured to make any colour.

Credits

Design images: photos of the unlit Sharp EL-8 display and the full set of lit numerals in a web museum for music technology and old calculators (**johnwolff.id.au/calculators/Sharp/EL8-8M/EL8-8M.htm**). The full set of lit numerals is linked at the end of the “Operator’s display” section.

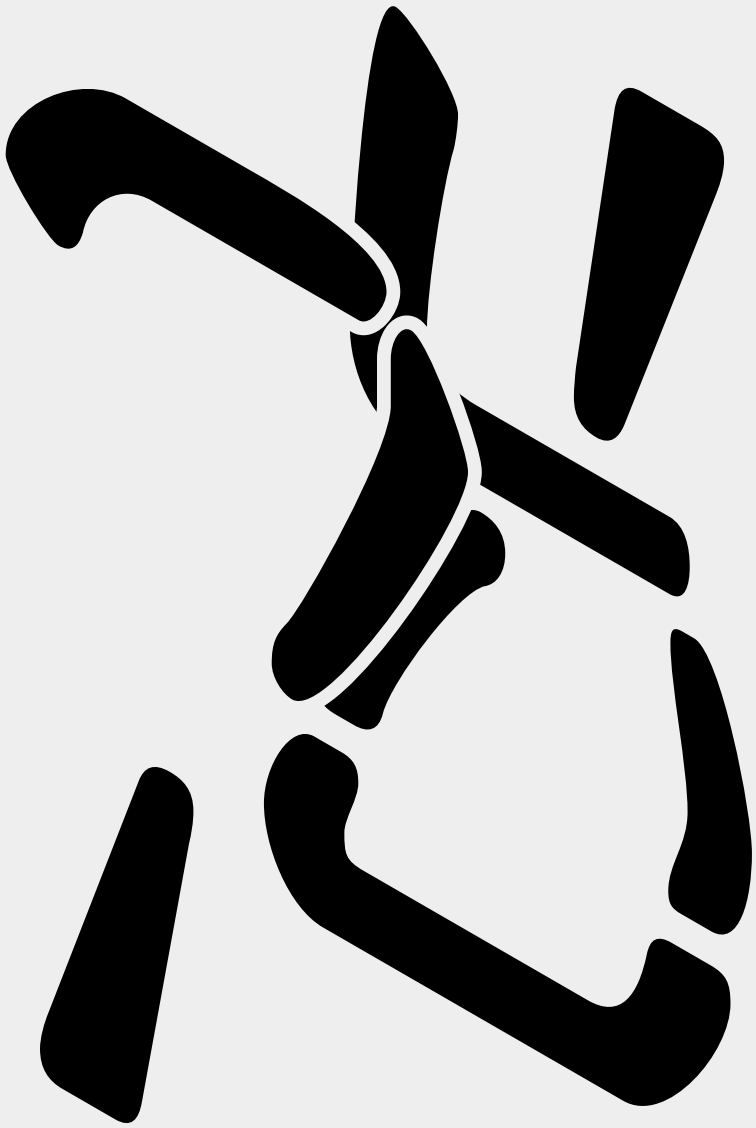
Information: the wikipedia page for the Sharp EL-8 and the above-mentioned museum site.

Layers

cursiv8 has 2 layers: lit segments and unlit segments.

name	OT feature	example
lit segments	none	7
unlit segments	stylistic set 1 (ss01)	8

These can go in either order, as they don't overlap at all. However, if you want to apply effects such as shadow or glow to the lit layer, then you should position the lit layer above the unlit layer.



Characters

Numerals

1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	0

Decimal point

The cursiv8 decimal point sits in the lower-right of each unit:

1.234	100.00	0.91

Other characters

+	−	×	÷

Note 1: cursiv8 uses the dot operator for multiplication.

Note 2: the unicode hyphen-minus (U+002D, -) and minus sign (U+2212, −) both produce the minus operator in cursiv8.

Note 3: the unicode slash (U+002F, /) and divide sign (U+00F7, ÷) both produce the divide operator in cursiv8.

Extra Features

Proportional figures (pnum)

Activating the ‘proportional figures’ OT feature (pnum) sets the width of the numerals, decimal point, and maths operators to be proportionate to the width of the glyphs instead of fixed to the width of the displays.

This feature doesn’t affect the unlit segments (ss01) or precomposed glyphs (ss02).

777 777 (default)	777 777 (pnum on)
1010101 1010101 (default)	1010101 1010101 (pnum on)
1+2-3×4 1+2-3×4 (default)	1+2-3×4 1+2-3×4 (pnum on)
0/0 0/0 (default)	0/0 0/0 (pnum on)
1969 1969 (default)	1969 1969 (pnum on)
1 0 6 6 1 0 6 6 (default)	1 0 6 6 1 0 6 6 (pnum on)

Precomposed glyphs (ss02)

Activating stylistic set 2 (ss02) produces pre-composed glyphs with filled lit segments and outlined unlit segments. This affects the numerals and maths operators, but not the decimal point.

13579	88888
13579 (ss02 off)	13579 (ss02 on)

Bottom-left decimal point (cv01)

Activating character variant 1 (cv01) moves the decimal point from the bottom-right of the current numeral to the bottom-left of the next numeral.

1.2.3.4	1.2.3.4
1.2.3.4 (cv01 off)	1.2.3.4 (cv01 on)

Spaces to empty tubes (cv02 to 05)

Activating character variant 2-5 (cv02-05) replaces the space and non-breaking space with every segment of the numeral or operator display; cv02 and 03 produce the numeral display with solid and outlined segments, while cv04 and 05 do the same for the operator display.

(default)	(cv02 on)	(cv03 on)	(cv04 on)	(cv05 on)

Separate segments

Typing the lowercase letters a, b, c, d, e, f, g, h, or i will produce the matching segment of the 8-segment display (clockwise from the top: a to f, with g and h down the middle), or the decimal point (i). These segments overlap with each other as if they were part of the same unit; type a space to move to the next unit.

gh	abde	abcd	fgh	acdf
1	2	3	4	5

Separate outlined segments (ss03)

Activating stylistic set 3 (ss03) replaces the filled separate segments with outlined segments.

bcde (ss03 on)	abh (ss03 on)	abcdef (ss03 on)	abfh (ss03 on)	cde (ss03 on)
6	7	8	9	0

Condensed maths operators (ss04)

Activating stylistic set 4 (ss04) with proportional figures (pnum) condenses the segments (except the multiply sign, which only has one segment). This has no effect on the fixed-width versions.

+ - / (ss04 off)	+ - / (pnum on)	+ - / (pnum on and ss04 on)

Fixed-position decimal point (dlig)

Normally, cursiv8's decimal point will shift out of position if the tracking or letter-spacing is changed. Activating discretionary ligatures (dlig) fixes the decimal point in place relative to its numeral.

3.4	3.4	3.4
3.4 (default)	3.4 (+20% tracking)	3.4 (+20% tracking and dlig on)

tEggst

Introduction

Eggcrate displays

Eggcrate displays are maybe the simplest electrical display—just a grid of lightbulbs that are lit up like pixels to make the shapes of letters, numbers, etc. To prevent light from spilling to the side, each bulb is fixed in a bowl-shaped reflector. The look of this grid of bowls led to the name "eggcrate display".

Eggcrate displays can be plain bulbs, colour-stained bulbs, or even LED bulbs (for an enormous range of colours).

tEggst vs the other Analog Digits fonts

This font is unusual compared with cursiv8 and reLix:

- It's a complete text font.
- It has different weights: Light, Regular, and Bold.
- It has multiple possible combinations of layers.

Credits

Design image: a photo of an eggcrate display uploaded to Wikimedia Commons, taken by Wikipedia user Tomcatbk (**commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Eggcrate.jpg**), and a video of uploaded to reddit (**reddit.com/r/gameshow/comments/diqsk1/im_planning_on_building_a_set_of_game_show/**).

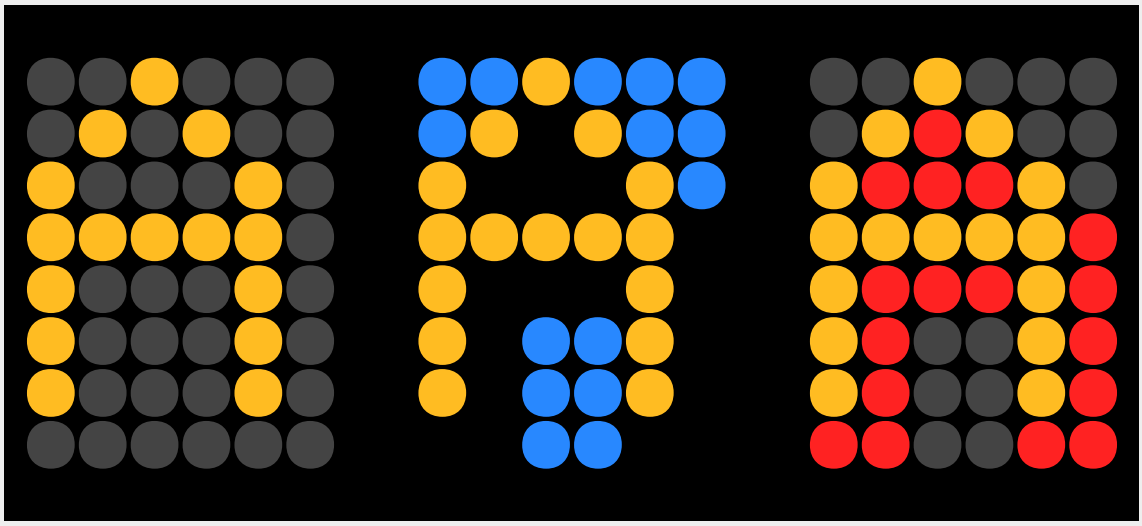
Information: the wikipedia page for Text Displays (the section on "Eggcrate displays").

Layers

tEggst has 5 layers: lit (default), unlit (ss01), shadow (ss02), unshadowed (ss03), and unlit-unshadowed (ss04). Unlike the other fonts, these can't all be used in the same layered graphics. Some combinations include: default + ss01; default + ss04; and default + ss03 + ss04.

name	OT feature	example
lit characters	none	
unlit "	stylistic set 1 (ss01)	
shadow "	stylistic set 2 (ss02)	
unshadowed "	stylistic set 3 (ss03)	
unlit-unshadowed "	stylistic set 4 (ss04)	

Note: although some of these sets are referred to as "unlit", that just means that those bulbs aren't lit up to form the character in the default glyph. They could be lit up as a background instead, for example.



Weights

tEggst has 3 weights: Light, Regular, and Bold. All three have the same characters and features.

FABULOUS PRIZES!!!

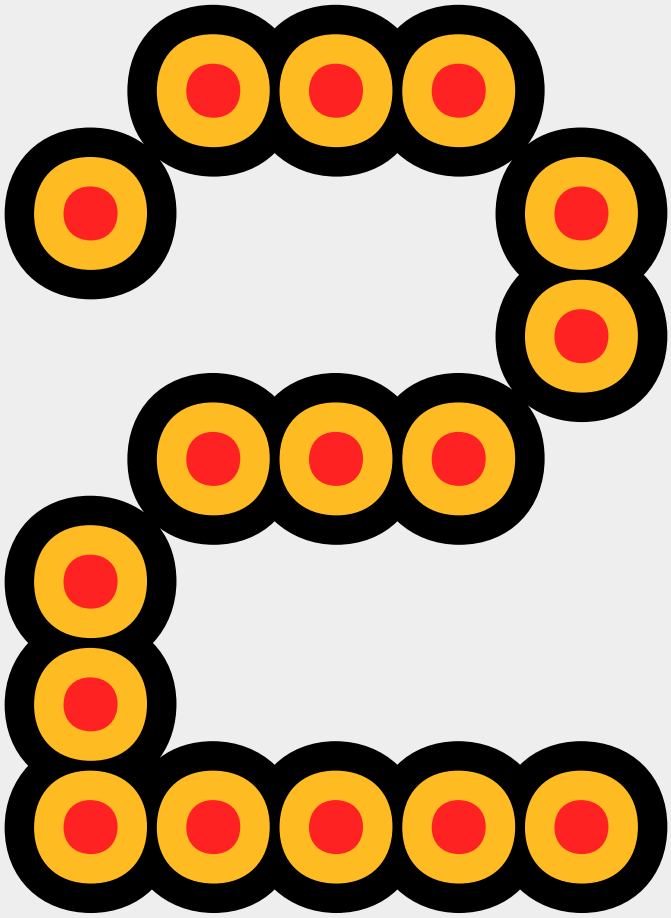
Fabulous prizes!!! (tEggst Light)

FABULOUS PRIZES!!!

Fabulous prizes!!! (tEggst Regular)

FABULOUS PRIZES!!!

Fabulous prizes!!! (tEggst Bold)



Characters

Letters

A	Á	Ă	Ă	Â	Ä	ẠẠ	À	Ā	Ą	Å	Ä	Æ
B	Ḃ	C	Ć	Č	Ç	Ĉ	Ċ	D	Đ	Ď	Đ	Ḋ
	E	É	Ě	Ê	Ë	Ė	Ẹ	È	Ē	Ę	Ẽ	Ə
Ʒ	Ǯ	F	Ḟ		G	Ğ	Ǧ	Ĝ	Ǵ	Ġ		Ḡ
Ꞡ	H	Ħ	Ĥ	I	IJ	Í	Ĭ	Î	Ï	İ	Ị	Ì
Ī	Ị	Ĩ	J	Ĵ	K	Ǩ	Ḳ	L	Ĺ	Ľ	Ḷ	Ŀ
Ł	M	Ṁ	N	Ń	Ň	Ṇ	Ñ	Ŋ	O	Ó	Ŏ	Ô
Ö	Ọ	Ò	Ő	Ō	Ø	Õ	Œ	P	Ṗ	Þ	Q	R

Letters (continued)

Ŕ	Ř	Ṛ		S		Ś	Š	Ş	Ŝ	Ṣ	Ṡ	ß
	T	Ŧ	Ť	Ţ	Ṭ	Ṫ		U	Ú	Ŭ	Ů	Û
Ü	Ụ	Ù	Ű	Ū	Ų	Ů	Ũ	V	W	Ẃ	Ŵ	Ẅ
Ẁ	X	Y	Ý	Ŷ	Ÿ	Ỵ	Ỳ	Ỹ	Z	Ź	Ž	Ż

Note 1: upper- and lowercase letters will produce the same glyphs. For example, both ‘A’ and ‘a’ will produce Ä.

Note 2: the Insular d, f, g, r, s, and t (D, F, G, R, S, and T) and the saltillo (ˈ) didn’t display in the standard font used here.

Combining Marks

tEggst has pre-composed accented letters (as seen in the upper/lowercase glyph tables) *and* combining marks. However, the combining marks are only a shortcut to the pre-composed characters. For example, typing ‘E’ followed by the combining acute accent will give the pre-composed letter ‘É’.

This is done via the ‘required ligatures’ OpenType feature, so it should *always* be active, no matter what settings you apply.

Localisation

tEggst includes localised forms for Latin-script languages via the localised forms (locl) feature. These will activate according to the typographic language of the text.

Catalan (CAT): centred periods between two Ls of the same case will become punts volats.

L·L → L·L

Polish (PLK): acute accents over C, N, O, S, and Z (upper- and lowercase) will become kreskas.

Ć Ń Ó Ś Ź → Ć Ń Ó Ś Ź

Romanian (ROM) + Moldovan (MOL) Latin: cedillas under S and T (upper- and lowercase) will become comma accents.

Ş Ţ → Ș Ț

Dutch (NLD): I with an acute accent followed by a J will produce the acute IJ. This works for both upper- and lowercase, as long as both letters are of the same case.

Í J → Ĳ

You can produce the same glyph, regardless of language, by typing the IJ digraph followed by combining acute accent.

Ij ´ → ĳ

Tahitian (THT): the turned comma modifier will turn sideways for use as the Tahitian ‘eta (and Wallisian fakamoga).

ʻ → ʽ

Activating the OT feature character variant 21 (cv21) will rotate the ‘eta back to a vertical orientation while the text is using Tahitian language, if preferred.

Marshallese (MAH): comma accents under L, M, N, and O (upper- and lowercase) will become the more cedilla-like accent found in Marshallese. As there are no M-comma or O-comma unicode characters, Zenimini includes ligatures for these letters: type the letter M or O followed by a combining comma accent to produce the Marshallese comma-accented letter.

ḷ Ṃ.ṇ Ọ.ṭ ḷ ṃ ṇ ọ

Numerals

1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	0
6	7	8	9	0

Punctuation

.	,	:	;	-	–	—	_	·	…

/	\	(	)	[	]	{	}		!	¡	?	¿

'	"	‘	’	“	”	‚	„	«	»	‹	›

•	*	**	⌉	#		’	‘	′	'

Symbols

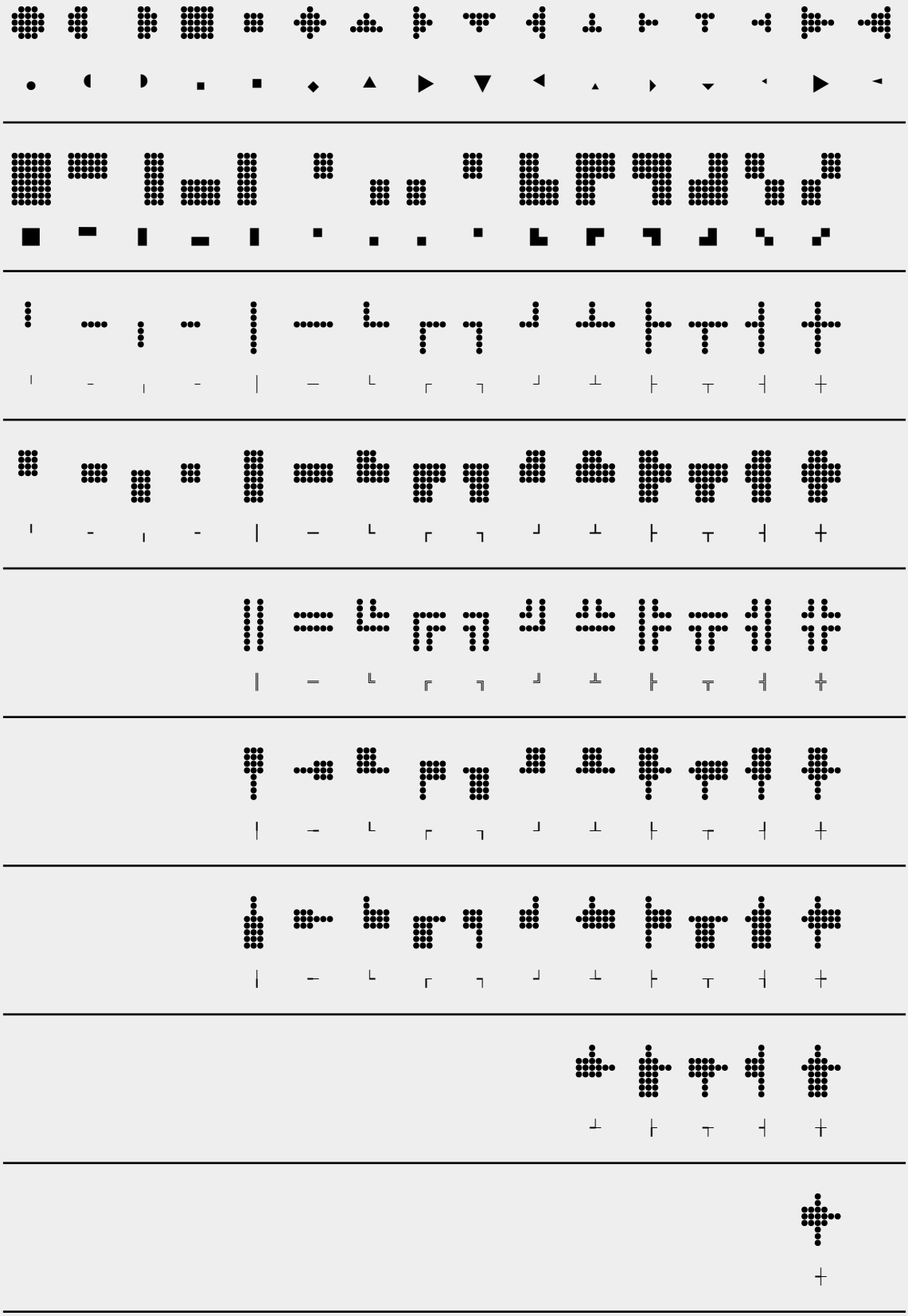
@	&	~	|	¦	£	$	€	¥	¢	¤	∞	°

+	−	×	÷	±	=	≠	<	>	≤	≥	^	%

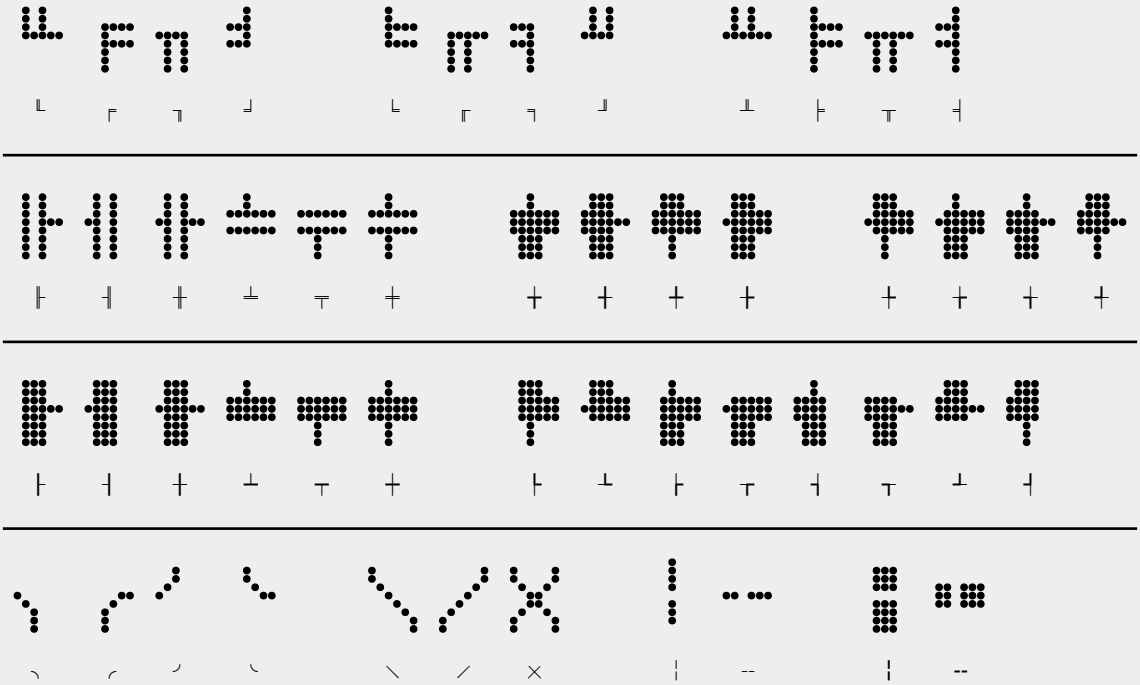
♡	♢	♣	♠	⚀	⚁	⚂	⚃	⚄	⚅		⚐	⚑

↑	↗	→	↘	↓	↙	←	↖

┤ Shapes, blocks, and box-drawing parts

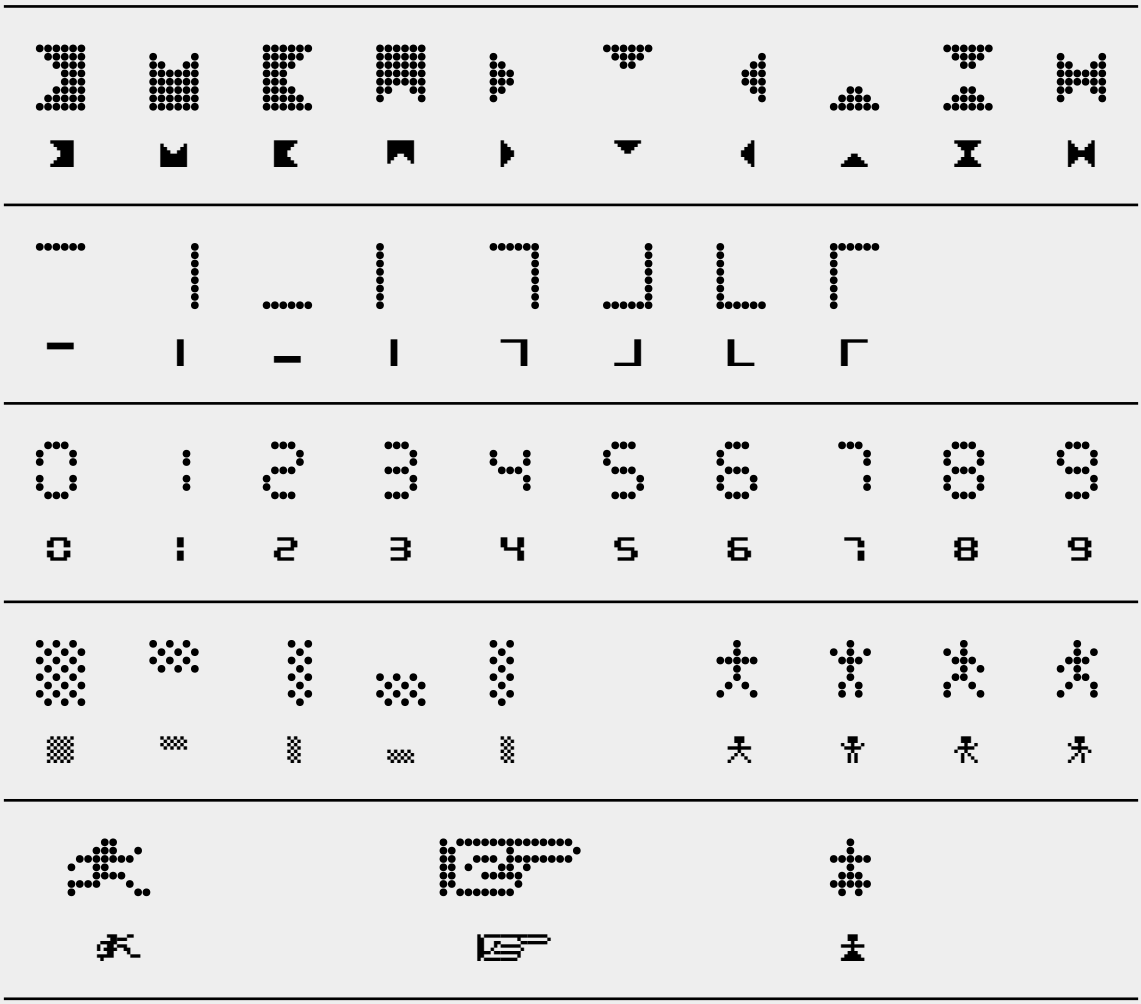


Box-drawing parts (continued)



Note: the block and box-drawing characters occupy up to the full width and height of the character (6 wide, 8 tall), so they don't have ss02, ss03, or ss04 variants.

Legacy computing symbols



Note 1: the corner, corner-cut, edge, and hatch glyphs (the top two rows and the left half of the third row) occupy up to the full width and height of the character (6 wide, 8 tall), so they don't have ss02, ss03, or ss04 variants.

Note 2: look at that little freak go! :D Yeah!!

Extra Info

Burnt-out bulbs

One prominent way that eggcrate displays can show their age is with burnt-out bulbs—the lightbulb equivalent of dead pixels. tEggst doesn't have any way of representing this using font tech, but you can achieve a similar effect by converting the text to pixels or curves and replacing some of the "live" bulbs with "dead" ones. However, this process can be time-consuming.

Extra Features

Numeral variants (cv01 to 19 and zero)

Activating character variants 1 through 19 (cv01-19), and the “slashed zero” OpenType feature (zero), swaps the matching numerals for variants: cv01 and 11 are variants of numeral 1; cv02 and 12 are variants of numeral 2; etc.

(default)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
(first-level character variant on (cv01-10)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
(second-level character variant on (cv11-19 and slashed zero))	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0

Note: in tEggst, the “slashed zero” feature un-slashes 0 instead.

Inverted hatching (ss05)

Activating stylistic set 5 (ss05) inverts the hatching characters.

(default)	(default)	(default)	(default)	(default)
(ss05 on)	(ss05 on)	(ss05 on)	(ss05 on)	(ss05 on)

Alternate pointing hand (ss06)

Activating stylistic set 6 (ss06) replaces the middle and right parts of the pointing hand with a closed fist.

(default)	(ss06 on)

Alternate numeral sets (ss07 to 09)

Activating stylistic set 7 (ss07) replaces the numerals 1 to 9 and 0 with pipped dice, and stylistic set 8 (ss08) replaces them with the pip patterns only. Activating stylistic set 9 (ss09) replaces them with seven-segment numerals.

(default)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
(ss07 on)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
(ss08 on)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
(ss09 on)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0

Card icons (dlig)

Activating discretionary ligatures (dlig) enables icon ligatures for both poker and tarot cards. Typing an icon's code (in all-caps) will convert the code to the icon. Some icons have alternative codes (on separate lines in the table below).

You can add an underscore between any rank and suit pair (including the numbers 2 to 10) to set the icons side by side without (hopefully) causing problems for text-to-speech (TTS) software. For example, instead of ACEHEARTS (🂱) you could instead type ACE_HEARTS (🂱).

🂡	🂫	🂭	🂮	🂾	🃁	🃑	🃁
ACE	JACK	QUEEN	KING	HEARTS	DIAMONDS	CLUBS	SPADES
🃘	🃚	🃛	🃜	🃞			
MAID	DAMSEL	KNAVE	PAGE	KNIGHT			
🂲	🃀	🃁	🃂	🃄	🃅	🃆	🃇
CUPS GOBLETS CHALICES VESSELS	COINS	RINGS	PENTACLE DISKS	WANDS RODS	STAVES STAFFS	BATONS	SWORDS BLADES

Note 1: PENTACLE is spelt without the S due to the 8-character limit imposed on ligatures in Affinity Publisher (at the last time I checked).

Note 2: to display characters next to one another, you can also use a zero-width space (U+200B).

Gaelic type (ss10)

Activating stylistic set 10 (ss10) replaces specific letters with their Gaelic type equivalents, and replaces the ampersand with the Tironian et. The KNIGHT icon (enabled with discretionary ligatures) also changes with this stylistic set.

(default)	D	Ḋ	F	Ḟ	G	Ġ	R	S	Ṡ	T	Ṫ	&
(ss10 on)	D	Ḋ	F	Ḟ	G	Ġ	R	S	Ṡ	T	Ṫ	&

Left-running figure (cv22)

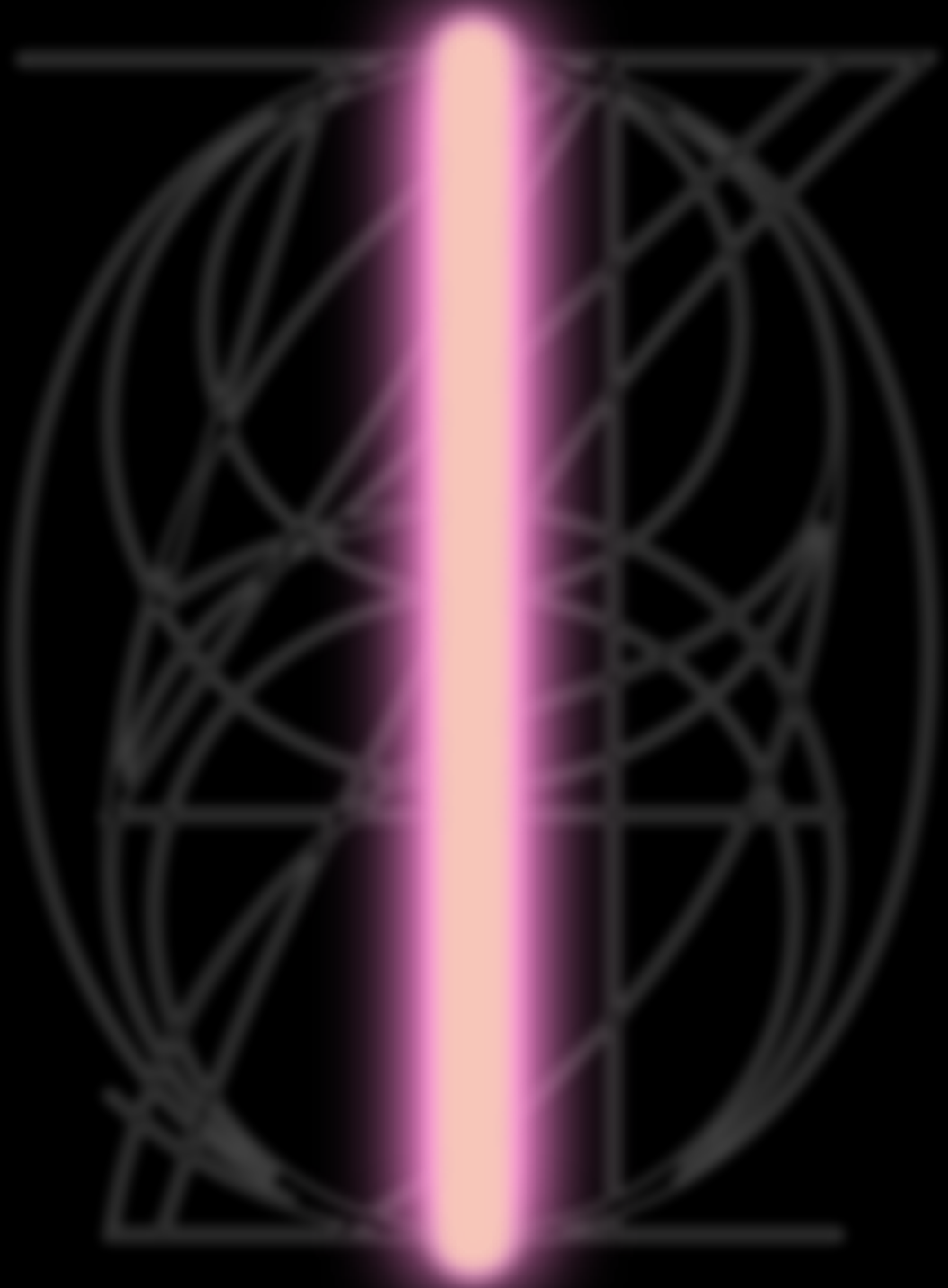
Activating character variant 22 (cv22) switches the direction of the running figure from right to left.

(default) (cv22 on)

Left-pointing hand (cv23)

Activating character variant 23 (cv23) switches the direction of the pointing hand from right to left.

(default) (cv23 on) (ss06 on and cv23 on)



reLix

Introduction

Lightguide displays

Lightguide displays are of stacks of transparent plastic layers etched with a numeral (or other character), each with a small lightbulb at the edge of the layer. When a bulb is switched on, its light passes through the clear plastic, hits the etched character, and scatters, making the character seem to glow against a dark background.

The technology was first patented in the early 20th century, but was only used for alphanumeric readouts starting in the 1950s with the rise of computers in science and business (including in pinball machines). They later fell out of favour with the rise of light-emitting diodes (LEDs), but the basic principle of edge-lighting is still occasionally used in more advanced displays.

Note: reLix is pronounced “re-Lix”, not like “relics”.

Credits

Design image: photos from an online auction of lightguide displays (**electricstuff.co.uk/auctions.html**); a youtube video by electronics account 50sTransistorRadios (**youtube.com/watch?v=5Om8SCLDTIE**); and a photo of a multimeter display uploaded to Wikimedia Commons by Wikipedia user Thatbrock (**commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Edge_lit.JPG**), from which the non-numeral symbols were taken.

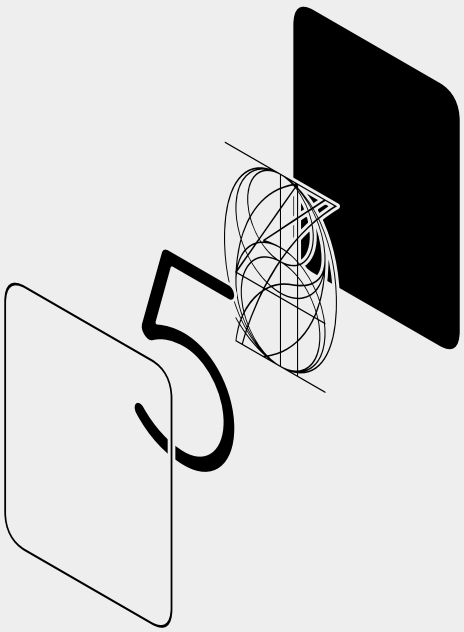
Information: the wikipedia page for lightguide displays.

Layers

reLix has 4 layers: the unit outline, lit characters, unlit etching stacks, and the unit background.

name	OT feature	example
unit **outline**	none, type lowercase o	
lit character	none	4
unlit etching **stack**	stylistic set 2 (ss02)	
unit **background**	none, type uppercase O	

Note: in a real lightguide display the lit character would be midway through the stack (except for the characters etched in the front and back acrylics), meaning there should be one layer for the unlit etchings in front and another layer for those behind the lit character. However, the etchings in front of the lit layer don't noticeably block the light, so, to simplify the font, all unlit etchings are condensed into one layer.



Characters

Numerals

1	2	3	4	5
1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	0
6	7	8	9	0

Decimal point

The reLix decimal point sits in the lower-left of each unit:

1.234	100.00	0.91
1.234	100.00	0.91

Other characters

reLix includes several other characters:

+	—	A/B
+	-	A/B (ligature)

Note 1: the unicode hyphen-minus (U+002D, -) and minus sign (U+2212, −) both produce the minus operator in reLix.

Note 2: A/B may be for an incremental encoder output.

Extra Features

Proportional figures (pnum)

Activating the ‘proportional figures’ OT feature (pnum) sets the width of the numerals, decimal point, and maths operators to be proportionate to the width of the glyphs instead of fixed to the width of the displays.

This feature doesn’t affect unlit etching stacks (ss02) or precomposed glyphs.

0 0 7 007 (pnum off)	007 007 (pnum on)
7 + 8 – 9 7+8-9 (pnum off)	7+8–9 7+8-9 (pnum on)
7 3 3 – 9 9 6 9 733-9969 (pnum off)	733–9969 733-996 (pnum on)
A/B 0.5 A/B0.5 (pnum off)	A/B0.5 A/B0.5 (pnum on)
3 4 5 3 4 5 (ss01 on)	3 4 5 3 4 5 (ss01 on and pnum on)

Single unlit etchings (ss01)

Activating stylistic set 1 (ss01) replaces lit characters with single unlit etchings. You could use this to create your own stack order if you want to have a proper 3-dimensional stack, instead of the lit characters appearing on top of the unlit stack layer.

4 — 4 + 4 — 4 4-4+4-4 (ss01 off)	4 — 4 + 4 — 4 4-4+4-4 (ss01 on)
1 .6 1 8 + 1 1.618 (ss01 off)	1 6 1 8 + 1 1.618 (ss01 on)

Spot etching (ss03 and 04)

Activating stylistic sets 3 or 4 replaces the linear etching with lit (ss03) and unlit (ss04) spot etching. The change is most visible at larger font sizes.

1 2 3 + — A/B 123+-A/B (ss03 off)	1 2 3 + — A/B 123+-A/B (ss03 on)
1 2 3 + — A/B 123+-A/B (ss01 on)	1 2 3 + — A/B 123+-A/B (ss04 on)

Bottom-right decimal point (cv01)

Activating character variant 1 (cv01) moves the decimal point from the bottom-left of the next numeral to the bottom-right of the previous numeral.

98.76	98.76
98.76 (cv01 off)	98.76 (cv01 on)

Precomposed glyphs (ss11 to 16)

Activating stylistic sets 11 through to 16 (ss11 to 16) produces pre-composed glyphs with lit characters combined with various other characters.

25	25	25	25
25 (default)	25 (ss11 on)	25 (ss12 on)	25 (ss13 on)
	lit + unlit	lit + outline	lit + unlit + outline
25	25	25	
25 (ss14 on)	25 (ss15 on)	25 (ss16 on)	
lit + background	lit spots + outline	lit spots + background	

That's the end of the user guide—for now!

If you use these fonts in a project, please let me know about it—I'd love to see how it looks in practice!

Also, let me know if I made any mistakes in any technical info—I don't know much about electronics.

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